



QUESTS OF RABU SHIN

TALES OF THE KRASIS

PLAYER GUIDE

A Spoiler-Free Introduction to Vael Turog

FOR PLAYERS

This guide introduces the campaign setting, settlements, character connections, and expectations without revealing the adventure's villains, hidden locations, encounter solutions, or final choices.

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Welcome to Vael Turog

Vael Turog is a continent of striking contrasts: frozen northern seas, mountain fortresses, volcanic foundries, ancient forests, sprawling marshlands, wealthy trade cities, and desert ruins. Roads and sea lanes connect twelve settlements whose survival depends on trade, cooperation, and the courage of ordinary people.

The campaign begins in Greymoor Hollow, where unsettling changes among livestock and crops threaten a quiet farming community. The scope grows from local mystery to continent-spanning adventure. Characters will investigate strange events, protect settlements, negotiate with powerful institutions, explore dangerous ruins, and decide what kind of future Vael Turog deserves.

CAMPAIGN TONE

Heroic dark fantasy with investigation, body-horror imagery, moral choices, tactical battles, travel, and moments of hope. Characters are expected to care about people and communities even when the right answer is uncertain.

What Your Character Knows

- Magic is common enough to be recognized but rare enough to inspire caution.
- The twelve settlements have different customs and competing interests.
- Rumors of malformed animals and strange green light have begun moving along trade routes.
- No widely accepted explanation connects these incidents.
- Travel outside settlement walls is dangerous, especially after dark.

Creating a Character

Characters begin at 1st level and should have a reason to travel, investigate danger, or protect others. The campaign supports martial heroes, spellcasters, healers, scouts, scholars, artisans, soldiers, sailors, and social specialists.

Strong Character Motivations

- Protect a home, family, guild, temple, military unit, or trade route.
- Study unusual magic, creatures, diseases, ecosystems, or ancient ruins.
- Repay a debt to someone in one of Vael Turog's settlements.
- Seek proof that a missing person, expedition, or caravan survived.
- Expose corruption or prevent dangerous knowledge from being abused.
- Earn a reputation as a defender of ordinary people.

Party Connection

Before play, choose at least one bond connecting your character to another party member. Shared service, family friendship, a previous caravan, academic rivalry, debt, or survival from the same disaster all work well.

d8	Shared Connection
1	You guarded the same caravan.
2	You studied under the same teacher.
3	One character saved the other from a monster.
4	Your families trade with one another.
5	You served in the High Bastion garrison.
6	You investigated the same unexplained event.
7	You are searching for the same missing person.
8	A mutual patron sent you to Greymoor Hollow.

Background Connections

Background Theme	Possible Vael Turog Connection
Acolyte	Hillwatch Temple, Radiant Mercy, a forest shrine, or a local ancestral faith.
Artisan	Emberfall forge, Silverreach guild, Stonewake shipyard, or Blackroot craft tradition.
Criminal or Urchin	Silverreach alleys, Stonewake docks, smuggling routes, or Duskmire caravans.
Folk Hero	Defended farms near Greymoor Hollow or rescued travelers from a regional hazard.
Noble	A minor Silverreach house, military family, or diplomatic household.
Sage	Lunareth archive, Sunspire research tradition, apothecary, or traveling natural philosopher.
Sailor	Stonewake Port, Frosthabor, fishing fleet, merchant crew, or naval patrol.
Soldier	High Bastion garrison, caravan guard, settlement militia, or retired campaign veteran.
Wanderer	Marrowfen guide, desert traveler, mountain scout, forest pathfinder, or northern hunter.

Languages and Knowledge

Choose languages normally. Characters connected to Lunareth may know Elvish; Blackroot or mountain communities may support Dwarvish or Undercommon connections; sailors may know Aquan phrases; arcane scholars may recognize Draconic as a language of magical notation. These are narrative options, not requirements.

The Twelve Settlements

The following information is common knowledge. Individual residents may hold different opinions, and remote travelers often know only rumors.

Settlement	Region	Known For
Greymoor Hollow	Central plains	Farming village
Stonewake Port	Western coast	Trade harbor
Emberfall	Volcanic region	Mining and smithing city
Lunareth	Eastern ancient forest	Elven arcane city
High Bastion	Mountain summit	Fortress city
Marrowfen	Marshlands east of the plains	Stilt settlement
Silverreach	East of High Bastion	Trade capital
Duskmire Crossing	Southeastern desert	Caravan crossroads
Frostharbor	Northwest coast	Northern fishing city
Sunspire	Southwestern desert oasis	Ancient oasis city
Blackroot Enclave	Mountain interior south of Emberfall	Hidden stronghold
Aetherfall	Floating above High Bastion	Arcane city

Greymoor Hollow

Farming village in the Central plains. Stone fences, streams, livestock, practical traditions. A common starting point for travelers seeking honest work, fresh provisions, and news from the central roads.

Stonewake Port

Trade harbor in the Western coast. Ships, markets, temples, taverns, salt and tar. The fastest source of distant news, unusual cargo, sailors' rumors, and passage along the coast.

Emberfall

Mining and smithing city in the Volcanic region. Lava channels, black rock, ore, masterwork metal. Respected for resilient people and exceptional metalwork; visitors should prepare for heat and ash.

Lunareth

Elven arcane city in the Eastern ancient forest. Living trees, silver bridges, archives, ley magic.

Knowledge is valued, but access to archives and sacred groves depends on courtesy and permission.

High Bastion

Fortress city in the Mountain summit. Tiered walls, ballistae, disciplined garrison.

Visitors are expected to obey military law inside the fortress and keep clear of active defenses.

Marrowfen

Stilt settlement in the Marshlands east of the plains. Blackwater, boardwalks, hunters, herbalists.

Local guides are invaluable; outsiders who ignore the fen's rhythms rarely travel safely.

Silverreach

Trade capital in the East of High Bastion. Marble streets, noble estates, guilds, diplomacy. Wealth opens doors, but reputation, etiquette, and guild ties can matter just as much as coin.

Duskmire Crossing

Caravan crossroads in the Southeastern desert. Markets, toll roads, wells, desert traffic. Caravans exchange guards, supplies, stories, and warnings before crossing the desert roads.

Frosthabor

Northern fishing city in the Northwest coast. Icebound docks, hunters, lighthouse, frozen sea.

Warm clothing, dependable companions, and respect for weather are matters of survival.

Sunspire

Ancient oasis city in the Southwestern desert oasis. Golden ruins, wells, university traditions, dunes.

The oasis supports scholars and traders living among ruins whose oldest chambers remain sealed.

Blackroot Enclave

Hidden stronghold in the Mountain interior south of Emberfall. Roots, stone halls, living craft, guarded traditions.

Few outsiders know its entrances. Its people are known through rare, durable works of living steel and ironwood.

Aetherfall

Arcane city in the Floating above High Bastion. Visible only at great distance or under rare conditions; surrounded by legend.

Stories describe a city suspended in the sky, though most people dismiss those accounts as exaggerated traveler tales.

Map of Vael Turog



Roads, waterways, mountain passes, and caravan routes link the settlements. Travel times are intentionally flexible so the Game Master can match the campaign's pacing and the party's chosen route.

Factions and Institutions

Group	Public Reputation	Possible Character Tie
Argent Conclave	Lunareth's arcane authority and archive guardians.	Student, messenger, former apprentice, or skeptical outsider.
High Bastion Garrison	Professional defenders of mountain roads and settlements.	Soldier, scout, quartermaster, veteran, or family member.
House Varin	A wealthy Silverreach house known for philanthropy and research funding.	Employee, debtor, rival house, beneficiary, or investigator.
Hillwatch Temple	Stonewake institution serving sailors and coastal families.	Acolyte, rescued sailor, healer, or temple courier.
Radiant Mercy	Silverreach faith and charitable medical network.	Volunteer, patient, healer, or donor.
Blackroot Enclave	Secretive guardians and makers associated with ancient defensive traditions.	Rare emissary, descendant, scholar, or recipient of a Blackroot-crafted object.
Merchant Guilds	Trade organizations connecting ports, roads, mines, and markets.	Caravan guard, factor, artisan, sailor, or independent trader.

Travel and Daily Life

Roads and Safety

Main roads are maintained near major settlements but become rough, dangerous, or seasonal in remote regions. Most travelers join caravans or hire local guides. Night travel is uncommon outside military patrols and urgent messengers.

Coin and Trade

Standard fantasy coinage is accepted. Barter remains common in Greymoor Hollow and Marrowfen, while Silverreach and Stonewake Port rely heavily on contracts, guild marks, and letters of credit.

Communication

Couriers, merchant vessels, caravan networks, temples, and magical sending services carry news. Information travels unevenly, so distant settlements may disagree about recent events.

Law

Local law changes by settlement. High Bastion uses military authority; Silverreach recognizes noble and guild influence; Lunareth protects sacred and scholarly sites; ports enforce harbor rules; small settlements depend on councils, elders, and respected tradespeople.

Rest and Recovery

Safe lodging exists in every major settlement, but quality varies. Characters who build relationships with innkeepers, temples, guilds, and local leaders will find better information and support.

Character Hooks

d12	Hook
1	A Greymoor Hollow relative reports malformed livestock and asks for help.
2	A Stonewake merchant refuses a shipment because the grain is rotten inside.
3	A missing shepherd was last seen following green light along a stream.
4	A High Bastion contact asks you to quietly investigate matching symbols found in cargo.
5	A Lunareth scholar wants a strange crystal delivered without attracting Conclave attention.
6	An Emberfall miner disappeared after claiming the stone was breathing.
7	A Marrowfen guide found metal beneath a drained section of bog.
8	A Silverreach charity patient developed impossible bone growth after treatment.
9	A Duskmire caravan arrived without its drivers.
10	A Frostharbor hunter says the ice is cracking inward.
11	A Sunspire archivist seeks fragments connected to an old research vault.
12	You repeatedly dream of a floating city and hear the words: "Refinement requires iteration."

Campaign Expectations

Investigation Matters

Clues are meant to be combined. Take notes, compare symbols, question witnesses, inspect environments, and revisit earlier discoveries. A failed check should usually complicate the investigation rather than end it.

Communities Matter

Settlements are not merely places to buy equipment. People remember the party's choices. Rescue, diplomacy, public trust, and responsible use of dangerous knowledge can change later chapters.

Combat Has Objectives

Many encounters include civilians, unstable terrain, machinery, escape routes, or defensive goals. Defeating every enemy is not always the only or best solution.

Choices Have Consequences

The campaign explores whether suffering can justify radical change, who controls powerful discoveries, and whether safety is worth surrendering choice. Characters may disagree; players should keep those disagreements respectful and collaborative.

Session Zero

RECOMMENDED DISCUSSION

The campaign includes mutation, medical experimentation, altered bodies, animal harm, disappearances, environmental collapse, and threats to communities. Discuss boundaries before play and use safety tools that let anyone pause or redirect a scene without argument.

- Agree on the desired balance of horror, heroism, humor, roleplay, exploration, and combat.
- Decide how graphically transformations and injuries should be described.
- Establish whether player-versus-player conflict is allowed; cooperative play is strongly recommended.
- Choose party bonds and a reason everyone accepts the first Greymoor Hollow investigation.
- Confirm advancement method: the campaign uses story milestones.
- Decide how absences, character death, and replacement characters will be handled.

Player Reference

Name	Pronunciation / Reminder
Vael Turog	VAYL TOO-rog; the continent
Rabu Shin	RAH-boo SHIN; a controversial historical biomancer
Krasis	KRASS-iss; a term appearing in old arcane and biological writings
Greymoor Hollow	Central farming settlement and campaign starting point
Stonewake Port	Western harbor
Emberfall	Volcanic mining city
Lunareth	Ancient forest city
High Bastion	Mountain fortress
Marrowfen	Marsh settlement
Silverreach	Eastern trade capital
Duskmire Crossing	Southeastern caravan town
Frosthabor	Northwestern frozen port
Sunspire	Southwestern desert oasis
Blackroot Enclave	Hidden mountain settlement
Aetherfall	Legendary floating city

Campaign Notes

Important NPCs: _____

Unanswered Questions: _____

Symbols and Clues: _____

Promises and Debts: _____

Places to Revisit: _____

YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN GREYMOOR HOLLOW.

The fields are quiet. The villagers are watching. Somewhere beyond the stream, a sheep bleats with a sound no living animal should make.